



UNIVERSITY  
*of York*

MBA690

# York Online Programmes

Handbook

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# 1. Introduction

Welcome to York Online!

This handbook contains important information about the University and your programme of study. Please take the time to read it in conjunction with the Orientation Module and the [York Online Programmes webpages](#). Together, these will provide you with more information on the systems you will use, how to make the most of online learning, and policies regarding important topics such as award rules and student support.

Starting a programme of study at university may present new challenges, especially if you have been away from study for some time. It is important that you understand how your programme works. This handbook will introduce you to key information, including:

- the structure of your programme, including assessments and awards
- how to register for modules or to take a break
- key contacts, and the York Online community
- student services, and the policies in place to support your success
- the rules and regulations governing your academic work and conduct.

**Important:** this handbook and the Orientation Module are reviewed and updated every year, so remember to revisit them and note any changes as you progress through your programme.

## 2. How your programme works

### 2.1 Programme design

Your Masters programme contains a total of 180 credits, which is made up from ten 15-credit taught modules, and a 30-credit capstone project module (CPM). Each 15-credit taught module comprises seven weeks of teaching, followed by a short assessment period. The 30-credit CPM usually takes place at the end of your programme and lasts 16 weeks.

**Table 1: the York Online programmes structure**

| Module type             | Credit value    | Duration (per module)                           |
|-------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Taught module           | 10 x 15 credits | 7 weeks teaching, followed by assessment period |
| Capstone project module | 1 x 30 credits  | 16 weeks independent study                      |

The exact modules required for your programme of study are set out in the [programme specification for your degree programme](#).

### Award requirements

In order to achieve an award at the end of your programme, you need to earn credit for the modules that make up your programme. You earn credit for each module that you study by achieving a pass mark of 50 for the module's summative assessment, or by passing the module reassessment. If your module has multiple summative assessments, then you will need to get a weighted mean average mark of at least 50 across all of these assessments in order to achieve a module pass mark. In some circumstances you may also be able to compensate one or two taught modules in order to get the module credit (see the section on [Compensation](#) below).

In the event that you do not achieve all 180 credits required for the Masters award, then you might still have earned enough credit for one of two alternative awards: the Postgraduate Diploma (PGDip) and the Postgraduate Certificate (PGCert). If you have achieved enough credits, then you will automatically become eligible for the award.

**Table 2: Taught Postgraduate Award Requirements for York Online Programmes**

| Award                        | Number of credits required |
|------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Masters (e.g. MA, MSc etc)   | 180                        |
| Postgraduate Diploma (PGDip) | 120                        |

| Award                             | Number of credits required |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Postgraduate Certificate (PGCert) | 60                         |

Some PGCert and PGDip awards require you to complete and pass specific modules. However, all York Online programmes include a PGCert and a PGDip that lets you achieve the credit using any combination of modules. You can check the exact list of possible awards (and their requirements) for your programme in the [programme specification](#).

## 2.2 Programme duration and structure of your academic year

Your programme can be completed in two years of part-time study (approximately 18.75 hours per week on average), though you can choose to take longer to complete the programme if you need (see [Taking a break from your studies](#)).

The academic year is split into six online learning periods (also known as OLs) that are eight weeks long. Most online learning periods run consecutively without any break. There are two breaks in the academic year where no taught modules are running: one in the summer before the start of the new academic year, and one that coincides with the University's winter closure.

You may study one module per online learning period. This means you can choose to study up to six modules (or 90 credits) per academic year. As in most cases there is no break between finishing one module and starting another, your assessment may be due for a previous module as the next module starts. Reassessments, deferred assessments and assessments that you have been allowed to 'sit as if for the first time' also take place when new modules are running. You can choose to focus on your assessments rather than registering for the next module by [taking a break from your studies](#).

**Table 3: structure of online learning periods**

| Online learning period (OL) | Approximate dates                           | Duration  | Notes                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OL1                         | Early September - late October              | 8 weeks   | Start of a new academic year                                                                                                      |
| OL2                         | Late October/early November - late December | 8 weeks   | Starts immediately after OL1. Assessments may be due in January depending on the precise dates of the University's winter closure |
| Winter break                | Usually final week of                       | Usually 2 | No teaching or marking takes place                                                                                                |

| Online learning period (OL) | Approximate dates                  | Duration        | Notes                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             | December and first week of January | weeks           | during this period, but you may need to study if you have an upcoming assessment                                    |
| OL3                         | Early January - early March        | 8 weeks         |                                                                                                                     |
| OL4                         | Early March - late April/early May | 8 weeks         | Starts immediately after OL3                                                                                        |
| OL5                         | Late April/early May - late June   | 8 weeks         | Starts immediately after OL4                                                                                        |
| OL6                         | Late June - mid/late August        | 8 weeks         | Starts immediately after OL5                                                                                        |
| Summer break                | Usually last two weeks of August   | Usually 2 weeks | No teaching or marking takes place during this period, but you may need to study if you have an upcoming assessment |

You can access the exact dates of this year's online learning periods from the [York Online Module Schedule](#).

## Assessment timings for taught modules

All taught modules have summative assessments (which count towards your degree), and most include formative assessment activities too. Formative activities are a tool to help you develop your learning and therefore always take place during weeks 1-7. Most summative assessments take place in the module's assessment period. The assessment period runs immediately after your module teaching is completed, from the beginning of week 8 to the end of week 1 of the next online learning period. If your module has component assessments, these could fall in weeks 1-7, or in the assessment period. You can find a full list of assessments and their timings for each module on the 'Module Assessment Overview' page in the module on Canvas.

If you do not pass the module on the first attempt, you will be invited to attempt the module reassessment. Reassessments take place a few weeks after you receive your module result, while other modules are running. It is up to you to decide whether you want to prepare for the reassessment and study another module at the same time, or whether to focus on passing the reassessment only. Your Student Success Coordinator can advise you on the options for managing your workload.



You can learn more about the different types of assessment you will encounter during your programme in [section 4: Assessment and awards part 1](#) below.

## Structure of the capstone project module

Unlike taught modules, the capstone project module runs continuously for 16 weeks, and may require you to continue studying during the winter or summer break. During this time, you will work mostly independently on a final project. Your final project will need to be submitted in week 16 of the module. The capstone project module therefore requires a significant investment in your time, and we recommend you delay starting this module if you know of any upcoming events (such as a busy time at work, a holiday, a wedding) that could disrupt your studies.

## Managing your workload

Studying at Masters level represents a significant commitment and can often be challenging. The York Online programmes are designed to be flexible, and you can manage busy periods at work and other upcoming commitments by planning to [take a break from your studies](#). Taking a break from your studies will affect how quickly you can complete your programme as you will need to wait for the module(s) you have missed to run again.

Your Student Success Coordinator can help plan your module trajectory and expected end date with the [York Online Module Schedule](#).

## 2.3 Who's who in the York Online Programmes

Understanding when and how to engage with the key contacts below will support your experience and success as a York Online student. You can find further contact information on our [York Online contacts webpage](#). You can also learn more about the [University of York community](#) and [governance within your department](#) later on in this handbook.

### Student Success Coordinators

Your Student Success Coordinator will reach out to you at the start of your programme, and will stay in touch throughout your student journey. They are your first point of call for all queries. They can provide information and advice on a wide range of topics, such as balancing workload, and getting support for issues that impact your studies (including health, financial issues, or work related problems). They can also direct you to specialist support whenever needed.

**Remember:** you don't need to wait for your Student Success Coordinator to get in touch with you. You can contact them at any time during your programme by calling **0808 501 5166** (UK), **+44 1904 221232** (international) or by emailing [studentsuccess@online.york.ac.uk](mailto:studentsuccess@online.york.ac.uk).

## Academic Supervisors

You will be allocated an academic supervisor at the start of your programme. You can find your supervisor's name in [e:vision](#) (under "Your personal details") and their contact details in the [University of York Directory](#). Your academic supervisor will be available to discuss your overall academic progress and other academic issues relating to your programme. Your Student Success Coordinator may refer you to your academic supervisor if you need more specialist advice on an academic issue, such as your progress on meeting the award requirements for your programme.

Your academic supervisor does not provide the same role (and is usually not the same person) as [your project supervisor](#), who will work with you during the capstone project module.

## Module leads/coordinators and tutors

Each module is delivered by at least one academic member of your department, and large modules may be supported by a small team of tutors, led by a module lead or coordinator. Your tutor(s) can answer your questions about a particular module's content, concepts you want to discuss, and provide guidance if you have questions about your assessment.

The name and contact details of the module tutor(s) will be provided in the 'Getting Started' section of each of your academic modules. The precise roles and responsibilities of module tutors may vary between departments, so **always check the introductory material in your modules** for information regarding tutor details and module support.

## Disability support

If you have a health condition which has lasted, or is likely to last, twelve months or more which may negatively impact your studies, [Disability Services](#) can offer you support, advice, and guidance. Health conditions include but are not limited to:

- specific learning difficulties, such as dyslexia, dyspraxia or attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)
- autistic spectrum conditions
- sensory impairments
- mental health difficulties (such as anxiety and depression)
- long standing illness or health conditions, such as diabetes or chronic fatigue

Support is flexible and based on needs. You will need to make an appointment with one of our Disability Practitioners to determine reasonable adjustments for your programme and explore what other support options may be available to you. For example, you might benefit from adjustments such as extra time allowance in exams, or help meeting deadlines.

To access Disability Services support, you will need to complete the Disability Services registration form, which you can find on the [Accessing support webpage](#). You will be asked to

provide supporting information when you submit the form. Once we have received your supporting information, a Practitioner will be in contact to complete a Student Support Plan.

If you have any problems accessing the form, or have any other queries regarding disability support at the University, you can contact the Disability Services team by email on [disabilityservices@york.ac.uk](mailto:disabilityservices@york.ac.uk) or by phone on +44 (0)1904 324785 (you will be asked to leave a message and a member of the Disability Team will get back to you).

**Important:** If you have declared a disability as part of your application, **you will still need to contact Disability Services** in order to access tailored support for your studies.

Your department/school will have a Disability Representative, who acts as a liaison between the department/school and Disability Practitioners. They act as a contact point in the department/school for disabled students. Please ask your Disability Practitioner for your representative's contact details.

### Further Professional Support Services

The University offers help to students experiencing psychological or mental health difficulties via the Open Door Team. You can access their services by completing an online referral form, or by phone or email. Please visit the [Open Door webpage](#) for more details.

The [Student Hub](#) provides a wide range of student support and advice, such as producing official letters and providing advice on financial support.

You will also receive emails from the York Online Support Team, who provide administrative support for the programmes and respond to more complex student support queries.

**Remember:** your Student Success Coordinator is your first point of contact and can advise you if you need access to a specialist service.

## 2.4 Engagement and participation

Reasonable and consistent engagement within modules is necessary for learning and successful achievement on your programme. The University uses the learning management system Canvas to host your course materials, discussion boards and other tools to help facilitate your learning. You are expected to [log into Canvas](#) and engage with your module content regularly. You are also expected to participate in discussion boards and group exercises (where applicable), and you are strongly encouraged to take part in formative assessment exercises.

Important information regarding your assessments, module registration, and any student support requests will be emailed directly to your [University of York Google Mail account](#). It is

vital that you **check your University email account regularly**. If you are studying from a country where you are unable to access your Google account, then consider [setting up email forwarding](#).

The University's expectations of your engagement as a student are laid out in full in the [York Online Registration, Absence and Engagement Policy](#).

## Module registration

Once you have completed enrolment, you need to use [e:vision](#) to register for each module that you intend to study. The module registration deadline is 23:59 UK time on the Tuesday before the module starts, and is displayed in e:vision as the 'Key action deadline'. Don't forget that you need to select **and** pay for the module before the key action deadline in order for your module registration to be complete. You will receive an email confirming your module registration and the module details will be visible on the 'Your Study' area of e:vision.

If you don't wish to register for your next module, you need to use e:vision to [request to take a break in your studies](#) for the next online learning period before the key action deadline. It is important that you notify the University of whether or not you intend to study for **every** online learning period. If you fail to take any action before the key action deadline, then you will be placed on an [unauthorised absence](#).

## Illness

If you are ill and your ability to prepare effectively for or submit an assessment has been affected, you should submit a [Disruptions affecting Assessment claim](#) to request an adjustment - see section 6.1 below for more details.

If you are going to be unable to study for longer than two weeks (either due to illness or any other circumstance), you should speak to your Student Success Coordinator about [taking a break from your studies](#).

## Unauthorised absences

If you do not register for a module or request to take a break by the key action deadline, your student record will be updated to show that you have been placed on an unauthorised absence, and you will receive a confirmation by email.

An unauthorised absence will last for the online learning period where there was no module registration. Being placed on an unauthorised absence will affect your studies in the following important ways:

- If you are financing your studies via a student loan, being placed on an unauthorised absence will mean **your loan payments are suspended** until after you resume your studies.

- The absence will **extend your programme end date**. Be aware that the duration of your programme may be extended further than you expect, because you will need to wait for the next occurrence of the module(s) you have missed.
- You will **not be permitted to study** for the duration of the unauthorised absence - including sitting assessments. This means you will not be invited to any reassessments, deferred assessments, or 'sit as if for the first time' (SAIFFT) assessments that are scheduled to take place whilst you are on an unauthorised absence.

You can only take **two** unauthorised absences consecutively. If you do not take any action for a third consecutive online learning period, the University will assume that you are no longer interested in pursuing your studies and will [withdraw you from your studies](#) and the University.

## 3. Change your plan: breaks, transfers, withdrawal

### 3.1 Taking a break from your studies

Your programme is reasonably flexible, but if you need to take some time away it is important that you talk to your Student Success Coordinator as soon as you can, so they can advise you on the next steps. Taking a break from your studies for any reason is known as taking a 'Leave of Absence'. Rules about taking a Leave of Absence are covered in the [York Online Registration, Absence and Engagement Policy](#).

#### When to take a break

You can choose to take a planned break in your studies instead of registering for a new module. You can do this for any reason. For example, you could choose to take a planned absence because you know you are approaching a busy period at work; because you have an upcoming family event, holiday or religious festival; or simply because you want to complete your programme at a slower pace. This type of break has been designed to allow you to proactively manage when to study, and when to take a break.

If you are currently registered on a taught module and are receiving teaching (i.e. you are in weeks 1 - 7 of that module), then you can also request to take an immediate break. This will pause your studies straight away. You can request an immediate break from your studies for a wide range of reasons. For example, you may request to take a break mid module because your employer has asked you to work increased hours; because of health reasons; or because you are looking after a sick relative. This type of break has been designed to allow you to respond quickly to any unforeseen circumstances that are making it difficult for you to study.

You can also take an immediate break from your capstone project module (CPM) if you are still in the refund period (i.e. if you submit the break request by Tuesday of week 2). However, you cannot use this process to take a break from the CPM after the refund period has passed. For more information on how to request support during the CPM, take a look at [Managing disruptions during the CPM](#) below.

Usually you are not allowed to continue studying during your break. However, if you want to take a break in studies in order to prioritise an upcoming reassessment, deferred assessment or an assessment that you are being allowed to 'sit as if for the first time' (SAIFFT), then you can request to take a special break to focus on assessments. This will permit you to continue studying for modules for which you have previously registered, without requiring you to sign up to study anything new.

## How to take a break

If you want to take a break from your studies, then you should submit a break request in [e:vision](#). To request a break in your studies, go to e:vision and select 'Take a break in studies' (you can find this under 'Key actions'). Your Leave of Absence request will not be visible to University staff until you confirm that you are ready to submit.

Before submitting a break request, make sure you understand what a break will mean for your studies, by taking the following steps:

1. **Read our guidance about taking a break in your studies**, by visiting the following web page: [York Online Programmes: taking time out](#). This will provide you with more information about when you can request a break, when evidence is required, and the impact that taking a break will have on fees and any funding you receive.
2. **Speak to your Student Success Coordinator** about the impact that taking a break will have on your programme duration. Taking a Leave of Absence is likely to extend your programme further than you expect, because you will need to wait for the next occurrence of the module(s) you have missed. In some cases, this could mean waiting up to a year or more, so you should speak with your Student Success Coordinator and plan your trajectory as soon as you think you need to take a break from your studies.
3. **Check if you need to submit a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim**. Not all assessments are automatically deferred if you take a Leave of Absence. If you are unable to prepare for or sit an upcoming assessment, check section 7.8 of the [York Online Registration, Absence and Engagement Policy](#) to confirm whether you will need to defer the assessment.

**Important:** if you are financing your studies via a student loan, taking any break will mean your loan payments are suspended until after you resume your studies. This means that you might need to pay for your next module before your student loan has resumed.

## Requesting Repeat Study

If you encounter circumstances that negatively affect your ability to study, then we expect you to use the one of the following dedicated York Online processes to request support and manage your studies:

1. Submit a [Disruptions affecting Assessment claim](#) - if you encounter circumstances that negatively affect a summative assessment or your ability to study on the capstone project module, then you can request an adjustment (for example, a deadline extension or to defer your exam) by submitting a claim in e:vision.
2. [Take a break in your studies](#) - if your studies are disrupted for more than two weeks, or you know that an upcoming event will make it difficult for you to engage with your next module, then request to take a break in e:vision.

In both cases, you are expected to inform the University that you need support as soon as possible.

Very occasionally, however, a student may encounter circumstances that are so serious that they are unable to request support in a timely manner. If this happens to you, then you should consider whether you are eligible to request Repeat Study. We would usually expect you to request Repeat Study as part of a break request, though standalone Repeat Study Requests are also accepted. To learn more about requesting Repeat Study, take a look at the following web page: [York Online Programmes: requesting Repeat Study](#).

**Repeat Study is only approved in exceptional cases:** you need to provide evidence of a good reason why you did not take action sooner, as well as evidence of the circumstances that negatively affected your studies. If you need to request support for your studies, you should therefore **always** try to take a break or submit a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim at the earliest opportunity.

## 3.2 Transferring to another programme of study

You may wish to transfer to another programme of study due to changing academic interests or because you want to change the structure of your degree programme.

You might be permitted to transfer between York Online specialisms (i.e., different academic programmes offered by the same department) providing that:

- you meet the entry criteria for the new programme
- you are in good academic standing
- you are not trying to recoup failure in a particular module or avoid a reassessment through transferring
- you register for any additional modules required to meet the programme learning outcomes
- you pay any additional fees (for example, if transferring to a programme with a higher fee or if you have to take an additional specialist module).

There is no automatic right to transfer.

If you wish to transfer to a programme run by a different department, rather than changing specialisms within your current department, you will need to submit a new application to your desired programme. If you are offered a place on the programme, you will need to withdraw from your current programme. You will not be eligible for any refunds for module(s) studied while on your old programme.

If you are considering transferring, you should speak to your Student Success Coordinator as soon as possible.



### 3.3 Withdrawal

Withdrawal is the term used when a student decides to permanently leave the University before completing all of the modules on their programme, whether for personal or academic reasons. If you have achieved at least 60 credits at the point of withdrawal (for example, by passing 4 x 15 credit modules), you may be eligible for an alternative award to recognise your academic achievements (see [Award requirements](#)).

If you are thinking about leaving the programme, you should speak to your Student Success Coordinator as soon as possible. Further details on withdrawing are available on the [Leave the University webpage](#).

#### Assumed withdrawal

If you are placed on two consecutive [unauthorised absences](#) and do not take action or respond to our efforts to contact you by the key action deadline, the University will assume that you are no longer interested in pursuing your studies and will withdraw you from your studies and the University.

## 4. Assessment and awards part 1: submitting work and receiving feedback

### 4.1 Assessment introduction

Assessments and feedback are really important elements of your programme. They are the method by which your understanding of the modules you study is measured, and they are also useful tools to help you develop your knowledge and skills further.

The [University Assessment policies and procedures](#) lay out the institutional requirements for the conduct of assessment and the rules for progression and awards. These documents provide detailed information on each aspect of student assessment and are a useful resource if you want to know more about the central rules that govern how your work is assessed or how your award is calculated.

The following three sections of this handbook introduce you to key information about the assessment, marking and feedback processes for the York Online programmes. Section 6 below also explains how your results contribute towards the calculation of your final award.

### 4.2 Assessment methods

You will encounter two types of assessment during your time with the University: formative and summative.

#### Formative assessment

This type of assessment activity is contained within most modules. Formative assessments don't count towards your official module mark and are not compulsory. Formative assessments are designed to help you learn more effectively, by providing you with experience of taking the assessment, and by giving you feedback on your performance and how you can improve further.

#### Summative assessment

Each module you study will be summatively assessed. Summative assessments are used to evaluate what you have learned, and measure how successfully you have met the intended learning outcomes of your module. Summative assessments are used to determine whether you have passed the module, and summative assessment marks therefore contribute to your final award mark.

You will receive one numerical mark per module (unless the module is marked using a pass/fail method). Some modules are assessed by a number of components, for each of which you will

receive a mark. Fixed weightings will be applied to each component, which together will add up to 100%. The overall module mark is calculated as the weighted mean of the component parts. The pass mark for Masters level modules is **50**.

**Summative assessments are compulsory.** If you do not submit the summative assessment(s) for your module, you will fail the module and will need to take and pass the module reassessment in order to achieve your Masters award.

## 4.3 Assessment format and submission of work

The York Online programmes use a variety of assessment formats. For the purpose of assessment rules, these fall into three main categories: assignments, examinations and capstone projects.

Assignment formats include (but are not limited to) essays, reports, presentations, practical work and project proposals. You may also see assignments referred to as 'open assessments'. Students are required to electronically submit work for summative assignments to the designated submission point before a published deadline. Summative assignments must be submitted in line with the criteria set out in the assessment brief, which can be accessed from the submission point in your module in Canvas. You should take note of the formatting, referencing and word count requirements, and (most importantly) the deadline date and time, which are always expressed in **UK time**.

Examinations always take place online, and can be accessed from the 'Assignments' section of your module in Canvas. During summative exams, students are permitted one attempt to sit a previously unseen assessment activity or set of questions within a limited period of time. Details regarding when the exam is available to sit and its time limit are published within the module in Canvas. You should carefully read all instructions provided in the exam submission point prior to starting an exam. Most York Online exams are limited duration examinations: you can learn more about this assessment format in the [York Online student guide: Limited Duration Exams](#).

Capstone projects are substantial pieces of independent work, such as dissertations, performances, reports, or equivalent that are the sole or primary method of summatively assessing a capstone project module (CPM). Most of the rules for capstone projects are the same as for assignments, except for the [York Online Disruptions affecting Assessment policy](#) and [rules about reassessments](#).

No matter the format of your assessment, you should always ensure that you understand departmental expectations for referencing and word counts, and allow time to complete and submit your assessment before the deadline. Failure to meet these requirements could result in [penalties](#) being applied to your mark, or even cause your work to be referred for an investigation into suspected [academic misconduct](#).

## 4.4 Academic Integrity

Academic integrity represents a set of values and behaviours which members of the academic community abide by. To be a trusted member of this academic community you must understand and demonstrate academic integrity in your studies and the work you produce. If you do not uphold the values and conventions of academic integrity, you may be subject to the University's [academic misconduct](#) procedures.

### Academic Integrity Tutorial

You are given access to an Academic Integrity Tutorial in Canvas before you begin your first taught module. This module introduces you to key principles around integrity and provides guidance on how to avoid committing academic misconduct.

The Academic Integrity Tutorial is **compulsory**: you need to complete it to demonstrate that you understand the principles of academic integrity. You should try to complete this module in Canvas (including getting 100% in all of the tests) before you sit or submit your first summative assessment. Completion of the tutorial is a regulatory requirement for progression and award, so you may not receive an award unless you have successfully completed this module.

### Referencing requirements

Referencing is a key aspect of academic writing. Some referencing styles are more suited to particular academic disciplines than others, so departments at the University use a number of different internationally recognised referencing systems. The referencing system that your department expects you to use will be specified in the summative assessment briefs for each module. You are required to apply this system to your assessments, and the accuracy with which you use the referencing system may affect the mark you receive for the work you submit.

You can find detailed additional guidance about the referencing styles used at the University on the University's study skills webpage [Referencing styles: a Practical Guide](#).

### Submission of student work to Turnitin®

Turnitin® is a third-party text-matching software programme that compares written assessments with an online database of articles, books, websites, and pieces submitted by other users. To ensure the highest levels of academic integrity and in line with University Regulation 5.7b, any work submitted for a summative assessment will be submitted to Turnitin®. In accepting the [University Regulations](#) on admission, students have agreed to the University's use of this software package.

You can also use Turnitin® as part of your writing process, to help you check your use of source information and improve your understanding of academic integrity. To access the Turnitin®

submission points, or for more information on this software tool, see the Turnitin Training module in Canvas.

## 4.5 Academic misconduct

The University is committed to developing high standards of academic practice among its staff and students, and to safeguarding the standards of its academic awards to individuals. The University regards any form of academic misconduct as an extremely serious matter.

Students are expected to take responsibility for ensuring that their work meets the high standards of academic integrity set by the University. It is important therefore that you familiarise yourself with the behaviours that would constitute academic misconduct, such as plagiarism, collusion and fabrication. If a marker suspects that you have committed academic misconduct, they will request a formal investigation to determine whether you have committed an offence. You can find a full list of the forms of academic misconduct and procedures for investigating suspected cases of academic misconduct in the [Academic Misconduct Policy and Procedure](#).

## 4.6 Penalties

In the interests of fairness, transparency and to be equitable we have strict rules around deadlines and the quantity of work submitted, and we have clear penalties for any student when these rules are not followed.

### Late submission

**If you are not based in the UK, note that deadlines will always use the UK time zone.**

All summative assessments have a submission deadline, and you are expected to submit your work before the date and time set in the deadline have passed. However, if you do miss the deadline, then you will still be able to submit your work for a short period after the deadline has passed. This is called the 'late submission window'.

All summative work submitted within the late submission window, without [valid exceptional circumstances](#), will have marks deducted. The deadline for work is on the hour: for example, if the deadline is 13:00:00, work submitted at 13:00:01 is late. The penalties applied for late submissions depend on the type of assessment.

For **assignments** (such as an essay, report, or project proposal) and **capstone projects**, the late submission window lasts for five days after the deadline. Late penalties are applied according to the table below. 5% of the total available marks are deducted for work that is up to one hour late. Thereafter 10% of the total available marks are deducted for each day (or part of each day)

that the work is late, up to a total of five days, including weekends and bank holidays. After five days the work is marked at zero. The penalty cannot result in a mark less than zero.

**Table 4: penalties for the late submission of assignments**

| Submitted             | Penalty                          |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| Up to 1 hour late     | 5% deducted from available mark  |
| 1 hour to 1 day late  | 10% deducted from available mark |
| 1 day to 2 days late  | 20% deducted from available mark |
| 2 days to 3 days late | 30% deducted from available mark |
| 3 days to 4 days late | 40% deducted from available mark |
| 4 days to 5 days late | 50% deducted from available mark |
| Over 5 days           | Assessment mark set to zero      |

In the case of online **examinations**, the late submission window remains open for 30 minutes after the published deadline. The exam deadline is inclusive of time to upload work, so any submissions after the deadline will be treated as follows:

- Submissions up to 30 minutes late are accepted and 5% of the total available marks are deducted.
- Failure to submit an exam attempt within 30 minutes of the deadline will be treated as a non-submission and receive a mark of zero.

The penalty for submitting late for a module marked on a pass/fail basis is a fail.

These penalties don't apply to formative activities. It is not usually possible to sit or submit a formative assessment after the deadline has passed. If you wish to submit a formative assessment late, you will need to ask your module tutor whether they are able to accept and mark your work late.

## Marking limits for overlength work

Your school/department will set limits to the length of summative assessment tasks. For example, an essay or report could have a word limit or a page limit, or a video presentation could have a time limit. There are rules about how markers should treat work that exceeds these limits, and the mark you achieve may be negatively affected if you submit overlength work.

If your submitted work exceeds the maximum permitted length, then your department will apply a marking limit to your work. A marking limit means that your marker(s) will not mark any work that exceeds the specified limit. Anything written/recorded after the marking limit will be disregarded, and therefore will not contribute towards your mark for the assessment.

The exact specifications for any word, page or time limits for your assessment will be stated in the summative assessment brief(s) for each module. You should read this document carefully and ensure you understand what is required of you for every assessment you sit. Make sure that your work doesn't exceed specified limits.

### **Failure to submit**

If you fail to submit an assessment by the deadline or within the late submission window, without valid exceptional circumstances, then you will receive a mark of zero for that assessment.

There will be no opportunity to attempt the assessment again later unless you are granted a deferral or a 'sit as if for the first time' opportunity under the Disruptions affecting Assessment policy. If the assessment you missed was your first attempt to pass the module, then you will be invited to the [module reassessment](#). If you miss the reassessment, you won't be offered a further opportunity to pass the module (without proof of exceptional circumstances) and will fail the module.

If you are struggling to meet a deadline or to sit an exam due to personal circumstances, it is therefore really important for you to submit a claim as soon as possible under the [York Online Disruptions affecting Assessment Policy](#).

### **Find out more**

Further information regarding the penalties for late submission, overlength work, and non-submission is available in the *Penalties for Summative Assessments policy*. You can find the most recent version of this policy via the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#) webpage.

## **4.7 Feedback for taught modules**

The University considers feedback to be any part of the learning process which is designed to guide your progress. It may be formal, such as written feedback on an essay, or informal, such as a module tutor responding to your comment in a discussion board. The University has a responsibility to provide feedback that is timely, useful, and fair. We aim to help you reflect on your own learning and help you feel clearer about your progress through clarifying what is expected of you in both formative and summative assessments. In turn, you have a responsibility

to use that feedback to reflect on your learning. You may also discuss how you can progress and develop your skills with your academic supervisor.

The timings and nature of feedback on formative work will vary depending on the nature of the formative activity: please refer to your module in Canvas for further details.

Feedback on summative work will usually be received at the same time as your provisional marks are released on the learning management system.

## 4.8 How your work is marked

Your summative assessments will be marked against explicit marking criteria which will be made available to you in advance. The marking process may vary slightly, depending on the type of assessment:

- If you have submitted an assignment, such as an essay, report, or case study, then your work will be anonymously marked.
- Online examinations that take place on Canvas are not currently marked anonymously, due to the design of the Canvas quiz tool.
- Online examinations that take place on other platforms are anonymously marked.

Summative assessments for taught modules go through a moderated marking process. This means that initial marking is completed by single markers. This is followed by analysis of mark distributions and by sample marking by an appointed moderator or by a number of members of the marking team. This is to ensure standardisation across markers (especially in large modules that require multiple markers) and clear adherence to the marking criteria.

Once the marking and moderation process is complete, you will receive feedback and a recommended mark. **All recommended marks remain provisional until they are ratified by the Board of Examiners at a [Module Board](#).**

Summative assessments are marked on a scale of 0 - 100 (unless the module is marked using a pass/fail method), with the pass mark set at 50. The postgraduate marking scale for Masters level modules is as follows:

- 70 - 100: distinguished performance at postgraduate level
- 60 - 69: good performance at postgraduate level
- 50 - 59: satisfactory performance at postgraduate level
- 0 - 49: fail

Note that marks between 40 and 49 are considered 'marginal fails', and are therefore potentially compensatable. Marks of 0 - 39 are outright fails and cannot be compensated. Any fail mark on



pass/fail modules are outright fails. For information on rules regarding reassessment and compensation, see [What happens if I fail a taught module?](#) below.

## Stepped marking

Some departments/schools mark assessments to the full scale, which means that your work could receive any mark between 0 and 100, depending on how well you have met the marking criteria.

Other departments/schools use stepped marking (also known as step-marking, fixed point marking, platform marking, notch marking, or categorical marking). This is a marking process that restricts the number of marks available in each class band to an agreed scale (e.g. low/medium/high). The process works by ascribing agreed marks or 'steps' within each grade band, most commonly -2/-5/-8. So for example, if your work is judged to be a merit standard submission, you could receive a mark of 62, 65, or 68, but no other mark between 60 and 69 would be available. Stepped marking therefore restricts the marking scale to a number of steps within each boundary in order to provide more distinct criteria for each step.

If your department/school is using stepped marking for your assessment, this will be stated in the key information about the assessment provided in the 'Module Assessment Overview' page of the module in Canvas.

To learn more about stepped marking at the University of York, please see the *Additional guidance on assessment* document, which is part of the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#).

## 4.9 Notification of Results

When the marking and moderation process has been completed for all students who attempted the assessment, provisional marks are uploaded to Canvas. **The mark shown on Canvas is for information purposes only** and does not display any [penalties](#) (for example, for late submission or [academic misconduct](#)). For taught modules, we aim to publish provisional marks and provide feedback for each summative assessment within 25 working days (not including weekends, bank holidays, or University closure days) of the examination or assignment submission deadline. You will be notified via Canvas announcement or email when they are ready. If there are any delays in releasing your provisional marks and feedback, you will be advised of this as soon as possible.

Your mark for the module will be released in [e:vision](#) after all summative assessment marks for the module have been released on Canvas. **The module marks provided in e:vision are the official marks that will be used to calculate your award**, after they have been approved by the Board of Examiners. The marks in e:vision may differ from the marks in Canvas as they will include any penalties that have been applied to your mark(s). If your module consisted of more than one summative assessment, your module mark will be the rounded weighted mean average

mark of all of your summative assessment marks. You can find your available marks in e:vision under 'Your study', 'Module and assessment results'.

## **Approval of module marks by the Board of Examiners**

It is important to note that all marks remain provisional until ratified by the Board of Examiners. After the module has been completed, the module marks are presented for scrutiny by the Board of Examiners at a meeting called the 'Module Board'. Membership of the Board of Examiners includes the External Examiners for the modules or programmes specifically covered by the Board, your tutors, and (if applicable) other internal examiners. The purpose of the Module Board is to finalise and approve marks for the modules under consideration, after confirming that all queries have been resolved, and that any interventions (for example, scaling of marks) has been agreed and applied. All marks are presented to this Board anonymously.

There are six Module Boards scheduled per year, one for each online learning period, that consider assessment marks. These are typically scheduled two online learning periods after the module assessment takes place, meaning your marks should be ratified six to eight weeks after they have been released in Canvas. Approval may be delayed if the Board of Examiners agrees that an intervention or a further review of the marks is required. If this happens, the marks for the affected module will be presented at the next Module Board.

Once your marks have been ratified by the Module Board, they can no longer be changed, and you can no longer submit a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim for that assessment. You can, if necessary, submit an [academic appeal](#). It is important to note that students do not have the right to appeal against the academic judgement of examiners: marking standards are determined by the marking processes outlined above and therefore individual student marks cannot be negotiated. However, if you identify a clerical or procedural error, then please do report it. Details of who to contact will be available via a module announcement at the time that the marks and feedback are released.

You can learn more about marks approval processes in the *Board of Examiners for Taught Provision policy and procedure*, which is part of the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#).

## 5. Assessment and awards part 2: the capstone project module (CPM)

Capstone project modules (CPMs) act as the culmination of your programme, and are usually the final module that you study. The CPM is a 16-week module, worth 30 credits, and designed for you to continuously study part-time (around 18.75 hours per week) across all 16 weeks. You will be required to undertake a substantial piece (or pieces) of independent work, called a capstone project, supervised by an academic member of staff.

As the nature of CPMs is very different to the taught modules that you will have previously encountered, there are a number of unique policies and procedures that apply only to this type of module.

### 5.1 Project supervisors

During your CPM you will be allocated a project supervisor, an academic member of staff who will offer you one-to-one support throughout your capstone project. Where possible, they will have a specific interest and expertise in the area of your research. Your project supervisor plays a different role to your [academic supervisor](#), who is available to provide more general support throughout the entirety of your programme.

You should take responsibility to contact your project supervisor early in the CPM, and agree on a schedule of meetings (known as supervisions). Your project supervisor will have competing priorities alongside supervising your project, so you need to ensure that supervision meetings are confirmed in advance and that you meet agreed formative submission deadlines, to ensure that you get the best from your supervisor and receive timely feedback.

### 5.2 Academic standards on the CPM

As the capstone project module may be the first piece of substantial academic research that you have conducted, it is essential that you familiarise yourself with the referencing requirements, formatting standards and academic integrity requirements laid out by your department/school. The rules regarding [Academic Integrity](#), [academic misconduct](#) and [penalties](#) laid out above apply equally to the CPM as for your taught modules. You will also need to ensure that you receive ethical approval for any data collection you undertake in support of your research. Guidance regarding the academic standards expected of you will be provided in your module in Canvas, and you can also ask your project supervisor for additional advice.

## 5.3 Marking process for the capstone project

As a substantial piece of independent work, the capstone project may be marked using a slightly different process to taught modules. The two marking methods permitted by the University are anonymous single marking with robust moderation procedures, or second marking.

Capstone projects on the York Online Programmes are marked using the second-marking process. The precise steps taken during this marking process varies somewhat across different academic disciplines, but the fundamental principles are as follows:

1. Two markers will mark your work. The first marker is usually your project supervisor.
2. The role of the second marker is to review the mark and comments of the first marker, and confirm or challenge them.
3. The markers will then agree on a final mark based on the assessment criteria and a reasoned discussion of the academic qualities of your work.
4. In the event that the first and second marker cannot agree on a final mark, then a third marker or an adjudicator will be appointed to review the previous marks and comments and decide upon an appropriate final mark.

The timescale for the double marking process may take up to thirty working days to complete.

## 5.4 Managing disruptions during the CPM

The capstone project module is a continuous, 16-week, project-based module requiring considerable independent study. It is therefore really important that you **carefully plan when you will be able to commit** to this module. For example, if you know that you or a close family member have a medical operation likely to happen in the next four months, then you should consider whether to delay beginning the CPM until after that procedure (and the necessary after-care) has taken place. You can manage when to begin the CPM by [taking a planned break in your studies](#).

However, sometimes circumstances occur that you are not able to foresee or avoid. If this should happen during the CPM, then you should notify your project supervisor as soon as possible, so that you can agree on a new project timeline if necessary. Furthermore, if **unforeseen and exceptional** circumstances take place during your CPM that:

1. prevent you from engaging with the module;
2. prevent you from submitting the capstone project by the deadline; or
3. negatively affect your performance in an assessment

you should submit a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim as soon as possible.

## How can I manage my studies during the CPM?

The actions you can take during the CPM depend on how far through the module you are:

- **Before the module begins:** defer starting the module by taking a planned break.
- **Monday of week 1 - Tuesday of week 2:** [take a Leave of Absence](#) from the module by submitting an immediate break request in e:vision. You can take a break for any reason, but if you are using the break to finish an assessment from an earlier module, make sure you choose a reason that allows you to study (such as 'Cancel module registration').
- **From Wednesday of week 2:** submit a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim in e:vision. You will need to demonstrate that you have encountered **unforeseeable and exceptional circumstances** that are negatively affecting your ability to work on your project and provide independent evidence that corroborates the circumstances you describe.
- **7 days after your deadline:** submit a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim in e:vision. You will need to evidence good reason for your delay in submitting the claim, in addition to the usual requirements.
- **After your marks have been ratified by the Module Board:** submit an [academic appeal](#), citing exceptional circumstances. You will need to provide evidence of valid exceptional circumstances at the time of the assessment deadline, and evidence that you could not have disclosed your circumstances at that time.

Before submitting a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim, take a look at our guidance about submitting claims for CPMs on the [York Online Programmes: disruptions affecting assessment](#) webpage.

Acceptable grounds for a claim include personal, medical or employment reasons, but not motivational grounds, failure to recognise the scale of the research topic or to engage appropriately, or failure to manage your time (i.e. failing to balance competing personal or academic priorities that you could have foreseen, such as an upcoming personal event or reassessment that you knew about before you signed up for the module).

If your claim is approved, you will normally be offered an extension of your submission deadline. A deadline extension for the CPM is usually accompanied by a programme extension. If you managed to submit your capstone project during the late submission window, then you could be offered a late penalty waiver instead. Very rarely, a student may be permitted to take a break from the CPM, if they demonstrate they have grounds to repeat the module from the beginning. The most appropriate outcome will depend on your circumstances and will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

## 6. Assessment and awards part 3: policies and procedures

### 6.1 Disruptions affecting Assessment - taught modules

Sometimes personal circumstances can make it difficult for you to undertake an assessment at the scheduled time. If this happens, you can ask for help by submitting a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim in [e:vision](#).

Depending on when you become aware of the circumstances that are likely to affect your assessment, you can use this process as a **time-management tool**, or as a way to **retrospectively request mitigation**.

**Timing is everything!** We expect you to proactively plan your studies around your other responsibilities, so **always** use this process as a time-management tool for taught module assessments if you can. The earlier you submit a claim, the less information and evidence you will need to provide.

#### Using the Disruptions affecting Assessment process as a time-management tool

If you anticipate that an upcoming assessment on one of your taught modules is going to be affected by disruptive circumstances, then you can plan your time by submitting a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim **before** the assessment takes place. This means that you need to submit a claim:

1. before the assignment or project proposal deadline has passed; or
2. before the exam becomes available to sit.

Claims that are submitted in line with the timings above will always be approved, and you can submit a claim for any reason without providing evidence. You will be granted a deferral for an exam, or a two-week deadline extension for a project proposal. You can choose between a deferral and a two-week extension for other types of assignments.

#### Using the Disruptions affecting Assessment process to request mitigation

If you experience a disruption during an exam, or feel that your performance in an exam or assignment was affected by your circumstances at the time, you can submit a claim to retrospectively ask for support on the assessment. Make sure you submit a claim **as soon as possible**, and no later than seven days after the assessment deadline.

When submitting the claim, you will need to demonstrate that your circumstances negatively impacted your assessment and could not have been predicted. **Claims submitted after the exam**

has become available to sit or the assignment deadline has passed are not always approved, so try to sit/submit your assessment whilst waiting for your claim outcome if you can.

If your claim is approved, then you could be granted:

- a deadline extension (for a project proposal, or for other assignments in limited circumstances);
- a late penalty waiver (if you submit your exam, assignment or project proposal in the [late submission window](#); or
- an opportunity to sit a new version of the assessment 'as if for the first time' (known as a 'SAIFFT'. This can be granted as mitigation for an exam or an assignment, but not for a project proposal.)

## Find out more

To learn more about using this policy for your exams, assignments, project proposals and capstone projects, visit our guidance webpage: [York Online Programmes: disruptions affecting assessment](#). This page also provides information about what the adjustments listed above (such as extensions, deferrals or SAIFFTs) mean in practice. You should also familiarise yourself with the [York Online Disruptions affecting Assessment policy](#), which contains important information about evidence requirements and deadlines for submitting a claim.

## 6.2 What happens if I fail a taught module?

The pass mark for postgraduate modules is 50. Your first attempt module mark will be calculated using the weighted mean average of the marks from all of the summative assessments for a module, rounded to the nearest integer. If, for example:

- you submit an essay in week 6 that is worth 40% of your module mark and get a mark of **52**; and
- you sit a final exam in week 8 that is worth 60% of your module mark and get a mark of **47**;

then your module mark for that module will be **49**, meaning that you have failed the module at first attempt.

Failing a module at first attempt does not mean that you have automatically failed your degree. Depending on your mark(s), you may still be able to get the necessary credit for the failed module through one of the two following routes: reassessment, or compensation.

## Module reassessment

Module reassessment is a second attempt for you to achieve the module pass mark.

In the event that you fail a module, you will be notified that your module mark is below 50 and invited to attempt a reassessment. You will receive notice to prepare for your reassessment in good time prior to the submission deadline or exam date.

You may be planning to study a new module when the reassessment is due to take place. If you don't have time to prepare for the reassessment and study on a new module simultaneously, speak to your Student Success Coordinator about options for managing your workload, such as [taking a break from your studies](#) in order to focus on preparing for your upcoming reassessment.

You are eligible to be reassessed once on each module that you fail, regardless of whether your first attempt module mark was a marginal fail, an outright fail, or a zero due to non-submission. If you receive a pass mark on your summative assessment(s) but receive a penalty, or a marks cap due to academic misconduct that reduces your mark to below 50, you are also eligible to attempt the module reassessment. If you intend to take the module reassessment, then you **must attempt the reassessment when it is offered** - you cannot request to sit the reassessment later unless you have an approved claim under the [Disruptions affecting Assessment policy](#).

### *Why should I attempt the module reassessment?*

The primary purpose of module reassessments is to give you a second chance to be awarded the credit for the failed module(s), either by passing the module, or by meeting the criteria for compensation (see below). **If your first module mark was an outright fail (0 - 39), then taking the module reassessment is the only way that you can attempt to get credit for the module.**

We also encourage students with marginal fail marks (40 - 49) to attempt the module reassessment as there are strict limits about how many modules you are allowed to compensate.

**Remember:** you are only offered **one chance to take the reassessment** for each module you fail. If you decide to keep a module mark that is a marginal fail and do not attempt the reassessment, that marginal fail will be used to calculate your award. You cannot later decide to resit the failed module if you accumulate more than 30 credits of marginal fail marks by the end of your programme.

Unless your award is calculated using the Covid award rules (see [section 6.5](#)), you may also use the module reassessment to attempt to improve your final module mark. After the reassessment, your module mark will be calculated as follows:

- If your reassessment module mark is **higher** than your first attempt module mark, then it will be capped at 50 and used to calculate your final award mark.
- If your reassessment module mark is **lower** than your first attempt module mark, then the first attempt module mark will be used to calculate your award mark instead.



Your award mark is used to calculate whether you are eligible for an award with merit or distinction at the end of your programme. As reassessment marks are capped at 50 for any degree calculations, you should always sit/submit your first-attempt summative assessments rather than relying on the reassessment in order to pass the module.

To learn more about how reassessments are used to calculate your final award, see the *Progression and Award Rules*, which form part of the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#).

## Compensation

Compensation is a process that takes place at the end of your programme, after you have completed all modules and any reassessment opportunities that you have been offered. Compensation lets you receive credit for up to two failed modules, so long as you meet the criteria below, and can therefore demonstrate that you have met your programme learning outcomes. It is a method of helping students to achieve enough credits to receive an award.

What this means in practice is if, after reassessment, your module mark is a marginal fail (between 40 and 49), then you may still receive credit for that failed module. Only taught modules can be compensated: you can never compensate the CPM.

You are allowed to compensate modules to achieve the Masters degree if:

- you have failed no more than 30 credits of taught modules (i.e. you have no more than two taught modules with a module mark below 50 after the reassessment); and
- no module mark is an outright fail (i.e. none of your taught modules can have a module mark lower than 40 after the reassessment); and
- the rounded credit-weighted mean over all of your taught modules (including the failed modules) is at least **50**.

It is important to note that you will not know if you have met all of the above criteria until you have completed all of the taught modules that form your programme. If you receive a module mark in the marginal fail range (40 - 49), you will automatically be invited to that module's reassessment opportunity. If you decide not to accept the reassessment invitation, you will not be allowed to request the reassessment at a later date, even if you subsequently fail more than 30 credits or otherwise fail to meet the requirements for compensation.

**Remember:** you can only compensate failed modules if the module mark is a marginal fail (40 - 49). If you have a module mark that is 39 or below, then you can only attempt to get the credit for that module via the [module reassessment](#). If your module mark is 39 or below after the reassessment, then you should talk to your academic supervisor about whether you want and are eligible to work towards achieving one of the [alternative awards](#) available on this programme.

### *Compensation rules for alternative awards*

You are also allowed to compensate modules to achieve a Postgraduate Diploma or Postgraduate Certificate.

You can compensate modules to achieve the Postgraduate Diploma if the 120 credits that are contributing to your award:

- include no more than 30 credits of failed taught modules; and
- does not include any modules with a mark of 39 or below; and
- the rounded credit-weighted mean over all of the taught modules (including failed modules) is at least 50.

This means that the minimum requirements to achieve a Postgraduate Diploma are:

- 90 credits of modules that you have passed after reassessment. This could be from six 15-credit taught modules, or from four taught modules plus the 30-credit CPM.
- 30 credits of taught modules with a marginal fail mark after reassessment.
- The marks of all the taught modules contributing to the award need to achieve a minimum average mark of 50, after rounding.

You can compensate one module to achieve the Postgraduate Certificate if the 60 credits that are contributing to your award:

- include no more than 15 credits of failed taught modules; and
- does not include any modules with a mark of 39 or below; and
- the rounded credit-weighted mean over all of the taught modules (including failed modules) is at least 50.

This means that the minimum requirements to achieve a Postgraduate Certificate are:

- 45 credits of modules that you have passed after reassessment. This could be from three 15-credit taught modules, or from one taught module plus the 30-credit CPM.
- 15 credits of taught modules with a marginal fail mark after reassessment.
- The marks of all the taught modules contributing to the award need to achieve a minimum average mark of 50, after rounding.

## **6.3 What happens if I fail the CPM?**

As with taught modules, the pass mark for the CPM is 50. However, the rules surrounding reassessment are different from the taught modules on your programme.

Depending on the mark awarded, there are two outcomes if you fail the module at first attempt: resubmission or module failure.

## Resubmission

If your CPM mark is a marginal fail (40 - 49), then you will be given one opportunity to revise and resubmit your original project in order to bring the work up to the pass threshold of 50.

You will receive feedback which will lay out the required corrections and revisions. These corrections will typically include editorial corrections (such as improvements to your structure and referencing), or improvements to your analysis, arguments or reflections on literature already used in your research. You will not be required to gather more data, conduct further practical work or produce new/extended literature reviews. The feedback you receive will give you the information you need to bring your work up to a pass without further help from your supervisor, within two weeks' of full-time equivalent effort. You will not be entitled to project supervision during the reassessment period, though you can still access the University's pastoral support services.

If you reach the pass threshold after resubmitting your project, then your module mark will be capped at 50 for all award calculations.

If your work is marked at 50 or above, but you receive a penalty for late submission that reduces your mark to a marginal fail, then you will not be required to resubmit your work. Your fail mark will be entered into e:vision as your first attempt mark, and then your mark without the late penalty will be entered into e:vision as your reassessment mark. As with resubmissions, your module mark will be capped at 50.

If you fail the resubmission by receiving a mark of 49 or below on your second attempt, then you have failed the module and will not receive credit for it. You cannot compensate the CPM.

## Module failure

If your first attempt CPM mark is an outright fail (39 or below), then you have failed the module and will not be able to achieve the 180 credits required for the Masters degree. You will not be offered an opportunity to be reassessed on the CPM.

Further information regarding the reassessment process for CPMs is available in the *How to Mark policy*, which you can find in the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#).

## 6.4 Programme failure

You need to achieve all 180 credits available on your programme in order to receive the Masters award. This means you will **not be able to get a Masters degree** if any of the following conditions are met:

- you have a taught module mark that is an outright fail (39 or below) after the reassessment

- you have more than two taught module marks that are marginal fails (40 - 49) after the module reassessments
- you fail the CPM (either with an outright fail at first attempt, or by failing to achieve a pass mark after the reassessment).

If you cannot achieve the Masters degree, you might still be eligible to receive one of the alternative awards: a Postgraduate Diploma or Postgraduate Certificate. The credits required to achieve one of these awards is explained in [Award requirements](#). You can speak to your academic supervisor about whether you are potentially eligible for an alternative award, and what additional requirements (if any) you will need to meet in order to receive it.

## 6.5 Final Examination Board and Degree Calculation

At the end of your programme, after all of your module marks have been ratified by the Board of Examiners at a [Module Board](#), your academic performance across all modules will be reviewed at a Programme Exam Board (or Ratification Panel). Members of the Ratification Panel include the Chair of the Board of Examiners for your programme (or their deputy), the External Examiner(s) for your programme, and at least one other academic member of your department.

The Ratification Panel's role is to check and confirm the accuracy of the marks awarded under the University's *Progression and Award Rules*, and to ratify award decisions. The panel will not expect to change any marks, either at module level, or at award level. The meeting will review your overall results across all modules and then will formally recommend your award outcome to Senate. The Chair of the Board of Examiners and one of the external examiners in attendance will be asked to confirm by signature the accuracy of the award outcomes for students on each programme considered at the board.

The outcomes agreed by the Ratification Panel will then be ratified on behalf of Senate by a member of the Standing Committee on Assessment and your final award result confirmed. The University notifies candidates of their results after the representative of the Standing Committee on Assessment has signed off the Ratification Panel's recommendation.

After your degree has been calculated, eligible students will be invited to [graduate](#). Dates and further information will be sent by the Graduation team after you've received your award notification.

Details of how many credits you need for each of the three possible awards on your programme are outlined above in [Award requirements](#). You can also find more information about the award rules for the York Online programmes, and details of the role of the Board of Examiners in ratifying your results, in the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#).

## Merits and Distinctions

Unlike undergraduate degrees, postgraduate awards are not classified - i.e. you do not receive a 1st, 2:1, 2:2 or 3rd classification. However, your award may be marked out with merit or distinction if you meet the required criteria which are given below.

To be recommended for the award of a **Masters degree with distinction**, you must have achieved:

- a rounded credit-weighted mean of at least 70 over all modules (including the CPM); and
- a mark of at least 70 in the CPM.

To be recommended for the award of a **Masters degree with merit**, you must have achieved:

- a rounded credit-weighted mean of at least 60 over all modules (including the CPM), and
- a mark of at least 60 in the CPM.

To be recommended for a **pass at Masters level** you must achieve 180 credits gained through assessment, reassessment or compensation.

You can also pass with a merit or distinction for the Postgraduate Diploma. You can achieve a merit or distinction regardless of whether you achieve the award due to withdrawing early, or as a result of failing the CPM.

- To be eligible for a **Postgraduate Diploma with distinction**, you must have achieved a rounded credit weighted mean of at least 70 over all modules that contribute towards your award.
- To be eligible for a **Postgraduate Diploma with merit**, you must have achieved a rounded credit weighted mean of at least 60 over all modules that contribute towards your award.

You cannot get a merit or distinction for the award of Postgraduate Certificate.

The rules for calculating awards on the York Online Programmes, including the calculations for merits and distinctions, are set out in full in the *Progression and Award Rules*, which form part of the [University Assessment policies and procedures](#).

## Am I eligible for the revised Covid award rules?

In 2020, as a response to the COVID-19 pandemic, the University introduced revised rules for the calculation of awarding merits and distinctions. These temporary award rules were designed to recognise the difficulty of studying under such challenging circumstances. For the York Online programmes, these rules remained in effect until the end of 2022/23 (which ended in August 2023).

Which award rules will be used to calculate your eligibility to receive an award with merit or distinction therefore depends on when you studied with us:

1. If you started your programme in or after September 2023 (i.e. in the academic year 2023/24 or later), then your award will be calculated using the standard York Online award rules that are laid out under [Merits and Distinctions](#) above.
2. If you started your programme before September 2023 (i.e. in the academic year 2022/23 or earlier), but the modules that you completed before September 2023 cannot contribute towards your award, then your award will be calculated using the standard York Online award rules that are laid out under [Merits and Distinctions](#) above. For example: if you started your programme in January 2023, but took a Leave of Absence and returned to your first module in September 2023, then your final award will be calculated using the standard rules.
3. If you studied on any modules that could contribute to your award between March 2020 and August 2023 **and** continued to study modules in or after September 2023, then your eligibility to receive a merit or distinction will be calculated using the best outcome between the Covid award rules and the standard York Online award rules that are laid out under [Merits and Distinctions](#) above. This means that you have completed study on at least one module that ran between OL4 2019/20 and OL6 2022/23, and have studied on at least one module in OL1 2023/24 or later.
4. If all the modules that could contribute towards your award began before September 2023 (that is, they ran in OL6 2022/23 or earlier), then your award will be calculated using the Covid award rules.

If you are unsure whether you are eligible for your award to be calculated using the Covid award rules, then speak to your [academic supervisor](#).

Unless you are on the MBA Healthcare Management Programme, you can find the revised Covid award rules in unit 2.2.2 (Awards rules & regulations) in your Orientation Module.

## 6.6 External Examiners

Every degree programme is overseen by an External Examiner who provides an external, impartial view on the procedures of the department to ensure the quality and fairness of our procedures.

The External Examiners report each year on the quality of the Department's adherence to the University processes and procedures. External Examiner details and reports are available below:

- [Computer Science programmes](#)
- [Management \(MSc\) programmes](#)

- [Master of Business Administration \(MBA\) programmes](#)
- [Master of Public Administration \(MPA\) programmes](#)

It is inappropriate to make direct contact with external examiners, in particular regarding your performance in assessments. If you have any issues or concerns, you can register these through [Complaints and Appeals](#).

## 6.7 Making an appeal

You can appeal against academic decisions. For example, you can appeal against failure of your programme, a Disruptions affecting Assessment claim outcome, or against an academic misconduct decision. The grounds of your appeal should be one of the following:

1. You encountered exceptional circumstances that negatively affected your assessment(s), and you were unable to disclose these circumstances before, or at the time of, the affected assessment(s).
2. There was a procedural irregularity in an assessment procedure that materially affected an academic decision in a way that disadvantaged you.

You cannot appeal against an academic judgement of your work (this is the marker's appraisal of the quality of your work). You also cannot submit an appeal on the basis that you are unhappy with the provision of a service (for example, feedback quality or teaching quality): in such cases, you should [make a complaint](#) instead.

If you are considering submitting an appeal, we would advise you to contact [York SU Advice & Support](#) for free, independent and confidential advice before you begin.

Further details, including how to submit an appeal, are available on the [appeals webpage](#) on the University's website.

## 7. End of your programme

The [Finishing Your Studies](#) webpage provides information about all elements of the completion of your programme - from awards, certificates and graduation, to what access you will continue to have to university systems and services. If your programme ends early due to withdrawal, your access to e:vision and [most IT Services facilities \(including email\)](#) will be withdrawn after 30 days.

### 7.1 Graduation

If you achieve the Masters award, you will be invited to a graduation ceremony. Graduation ceremony dates are published along with provisional future dates on the [Ceremony dates webpage](#). You will only be eligible to attend graduation after all of your [module marks have been approved](#) and your award has been confirmed by a [Ratification Panel](#). This means you might not be invited to the first ceremony that is scheduled after you submit your final assessment.

If you are eligible to graduate, you will be sent an email inviting you to register for your ceremony. Your University email account will expire shortly after your award has been ratified, so it is important to keep your personal contact details up to date on [e:vision](#) to receive information about your graduation. The [graduation registration](#) process takes place in e:vision and attendance is processed on a first-come, first-served basis. It is important that you complete registration even if you do not wish to attend the ceremony, so that the University can prepare to confer your degree *in absentia*.

You can find further details on the University's [Graduation webpages](#). If you have any queries regarding the graduation ceremony, please get in touch with [graduation@york.ac.uk](mailto:graduation@york.ac.uk).

### 7.2 Certificates and Academic Transcripts

If you achieve the Masters award, you will be asked how you wish to receive your degree certificate when you register for your ceremony. You will also have access to your certificate digitally via [Gradintel](#) on the day of your graduation.

It is not possible to receive your certificate before your ceremony. If you need proof of your Masters award sooner, you can request a [Confirmation of Award](#) letter after you have had your Board of Examiners Decision Letter.

An academic transcript is a full record of your academic study at the University of York and includes marks from all years of study. A digital copy of your transcript will be uploaded to Gradintel on the day of your graduation.

If you achieve a Postgraduate Certificate or a Postgraduate Diploma, you will be able to access your certificate and transcript once they have been uploaded to Gradintel.



You will receive an email inviting you to register for Gradintel, so please make sure you keep your contact details in e:vision up to date.

A hard copy of your certificate can be sent by request: to submit a request, email [graduation@york.ac.uk](mailto:graduation@york.ac.uk). Physical copies of your academic transcript can be purchased through the [Online Store](#).

## **Interim Transcripts**

The Student Hub can issue you with a PDF letter that verifies your module results. This is not a formal physical transcript but can be requested at any time during your studies. To request a verified copy of your module results, take a screenshot or PDF print out of your “Module and Assessment Results” from e:vision and email it to [student-hub@york.ac.uk](mailto:student-hub@york.ac.uk) for validation.

## 8. Governance

### 8.1 Departmental/School Committees

All academic departments/schools have governance structures that are designed to monitor the quality of their teaching provision. Within this structure there are a number of committees that each department/school must form under the University's [Ordinances and Regulations](#).

Between them, these committees approve new programmes and modules, as well as revisions and changes to existing programmes. They also consider student feedback and monitor student admissions and achievement.

### 8.2 Academic Reps

Academic representation is a partnership between the University of York Students' Union and University departments. Academic Reps (or student reps) aim to ensure that students contribute directly to the processes of reviewing, maintaining and enhancing the quality of the academic experience at York. You can go to academic reps with any feedback about best practice, concerns or suggestions about how the department or aspects of your programme are run.

For more information, visit the [University of York Students' Union Academic Reps webpage](#).

You can find out who your Academic Rep is by looking at our [Student Representative Directory](#).

### 8.3 Giving us feedback

Students are given opportunities to provide feedback on their experience of the degree programme. This may include module evaluation, end of programme evaluation, and student representation. Along with other mechanisms (such as tutor evaluations, programme reviews, and department evaluations) this allows for the resolution of problems. These evaluations also feed into future developments, such as curriculum design and course provision.

We take your views on your experience within the department and University very seriously. Your feedback is an important part of the University's programme of quality assurance and enhancement. By providing relevant and constructive feedback, you will help us to deliver the best possible student experience at York.

If you have any feedback or suggestions during your study, you can contact the Student Success Team to let them know by emailing [studentsuccess@online.york.ac.uk](mailto:studentsuccess@online.york.ac.uk).

## 9. York community

### 9.1 A community built on values

As a student, you join this community to pursue your academic interests and develop as an individual. At York, you will be challenged intellectually, encouraged to consider your place in society, and supported to achieve and to thrive. We want to empower you to think deeply, to explore ideas and experiences adventurously, and to use your time to become the best person you can be.

Learn more about the values of the University of York at [Together York](#).

### 9.2 Equality, Diversity and Inclusion

The University of York values the diversity of our students and staff and is committed to the creation of a positive environment which is fair, welcoming and inclusive, and where everyone is treated with dignity and respect.

Further information is available about the University's [Equality, Diversity and Inclusion](#) policies.

There is support available for anyone who feels they have been treated unfairly or have experienced [bullying or harassment](#).

### 9.3 Your online community

By starting a York Online programme, you not only become a member of your academic department, but also a part of the wider York Online community. A substantial number of postgraduate students at the University of York study online, and we want you to get the most out of your experience. The University offers a wide range of events, opportunities, resources and support to help you succeed in your studies and beyond, no matter where you are based. The University of York Students' Union has [community networks](#) that you can join, and many students create Slack or Whatsapp groups to keep in touch.

### 9.4 Wentworth College

York is one of a handful of universities with a college system and our colleges provide a focus of community, networking, and support. As a postgraduate student, you are automatically a member of [Wentworth College](#), unless you have studied at York before in which case you will continue to be a member of your previous college.

If you live locally or visit York at any time during your studies, you are welcome to visit campus and make use of college facilities.

## 9.5 Careers and placements

You may be studying to advance your career, as a requirement of your employment, or as a stepping stone to a career change. Whatever your employment situation, Careers and Placements is available to support and guide you, both while you are studying and after you have graduated. They provide resources and services such as interview and CV guides, and their Careers Consultants can review job applications and personal statements, or discuss your career plans. Quick questions can be sent directly to the team, and telephone and video appointments are available.

You can contact Careers and Placements via [careers@york.ac.uk](mailto:careers@york.ac.uk). Further information is available on the [Careers and Placements website for Online and Distance Learners](#).

## 9.6 Accessibility

At York we are committed to making our learning materials accessible and usable for learners. This means that we adhere to overarching accessibility guidelines and are always seeking to improve in this area.

Please see our [Accessibility Statement for Canvas](#) for more information, including:

- Guidelines that we are committed to complying with
- Accessibility features of Canvas itself
- How we design materials within Canvas to be accessible
- Known issues and what we are doing to improve
- How to report any accessibility issues that you experience

You will use a range of other platforms and documents supplied by the University alongside Canvas. These are created and used with accessibility in mind. If you have accessibility concerns about any of the platforms, materials or resources we provide during your studies, please feel free to make contact so that we can address your concerns.

## 9.7 Visiting the campus

All online learners are very welcome to visit the University campus. If you are considering visiting the campus, you may wish to stay in our accommodation, which you can book through [STEM Learning](#).

If you are an international student and you need advice about getting a visa to visit York or attend your graduation, then the University's [Immigration Advice Service](#) is available to help you. The team can be contacted on +44 (0)1904 324140 or [immigration@york.ac.uk](mailto:immigration@york.ac.uk)

For further location and travel information, see our [maps and directions](#) webpage.

If you would like to arrange a visit to the campus, please contact [york-online-admin@york.ac.uk](mailto:york-online-admin@york.ac.uk) and we will be pleased to help you. Please note that while we can arrange a tour of your department buildings, you will not usually be able to meet members of academic staff.

## 9.8 Make the most of your University Card

As part of your registration with the University you will automatically receive a [University Card](#), which is posted to your home address. You can apply for a replacement University Card via [e:vision](#).

If you decide to visit the University of York campus, then your University Card will allow you entry to the libraries for borrowing books or printing and copying. It also gives you access to other venues and facilities, and printing stations around the campus.

You are also eligible for a [TOTUM card](#), which along with other student discount apps provides student discounts and benefits.

## 9.9 The University of York Students' Union

[The University of York Students' Union](#) (York SU) is the primary representative body of all students at the University of York. It has full-time officers who represent your views to the University as well as events, workshops and networks.

[York SU Advice & Support](#) provides independent and confidential advice and guidance to students on academic issues, University policies and procedures, and personal and wellbeing issues. They can be contacted by calling +44 (0) 1904 323724 or by emailing [advice@yorksu.org](mailto:advice@yorksu.org).

## 9.10 If things go wrong

We hope your time with the University will be amongst the best experiences of your life. However, it is important that you know where to turn to should you experience any difficulties.

If you need help, please contact your [Student Success Coordinator](#) in the first instance. They can help and advise, and signpost you to the wide range of support resources the University has to offer.

# 10. The small print

## 10.1 Regulations and discipline

Our aim at York is to promote a community built on shared values of respect, fairness and compassion and in which students and staff can study and work constructively together.

When you enrol, you agree to accept and abide by the University Regulations. In particular, you should make sure you are familiar with Regulation 7 which is about student discipline and Regulation 11, which is about appropriate use of information systems. They detail the sorts of behaviour which are unacceptable in our community and explain our procedure for taking disciplinary action. You can learn more about these regulations, reporting student misconduct and discipline procedures on the [University's Ordinances and Regulations webpages](#).

## 10.2 Data Protection

The University needs to process certain information about its current, past and potential students as part of the necessary functioning of the institution as an education provider. In doing so, it must comply with the General Data Protection Regulation and the Data Protection Act 2018. This legal framework governs the University's use of personal data and is also concerned with the rights of individuals to gain access to personal information held about them by the University. The terms of the Act relate to data held in any format, including written notes and records as well as electronic data. Further information on [how the University uses your data](#) is available on our website.

## 10.3 Health, safety and security

We aim to ensure that all students and staff can work in a [safe and healthy environment](#).

## 10.4 Making a complaint

You can complain about your experience of a service you have received as a student within the University, whether academic or non-academic. For further information, visit [the complaints procedure webpage](#).

## 10.5 Disclaimer

We have tried to ensure that the information contained in this document is accurate as of October 2025. If changes are made, a revised handbook will be made available with a notification published on Canvas.